

What was it like to live in a castle?

A castle could be cold, damp, dark, smelly, and drafty. After all, it was built to keep enemies out, with huge outer walls, hefty corner towers, and narrow slits instead of windows.

Living rooms . . .

The lord's private rooms, called the solar, were in the strongest part of the castle.

Don't cross the water . . .

A deep moat filled with water ran around the castle. It kept attackers away from the walls.

Raise the drawbridge . . .

At the castle entrance, a wooden drawbridge could be lowered to let guests in or raised to keep attackers out.

The way in . . .

A castle had one main entrance, which made it easier to defend.

Look out!

Towers at the corners of the castle allowed defenders to see if enemies were coming.

This is a **concentric castle** from the 13th century. It has two outer walls.

